Strategies for Healthy Living and Longevity

NEXUS Method

for the Foundation Profile

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1. Introduction

There are moments in life when we stop, even if only for a fleeting instant, and ask ourselves a question as simple as it is uncomfortable: *Am I living in the best way possible for my body?* It's not a matter of years, or goals, or even success in the conventional sense. It's something more intimate, more silent. It has to do with the quality of each day, with the energy we have upon waking, with mental clarity, with the ability to move, to enjoy life, to rest. Ultimately, it has to do with how we navigate the time we've been given.

We live in an era that, paradoxically, seems to have solved almost everything... and yet, it has complicated what is truly essential. Never before have we had so much access to information, food, technology, and quick fixes. And yet, never before has it been so difficult to discern what is truly important for our health. We navigate amidst contradictory advice, fleeting fads, miraculous promises, and unfounded fears. One diet replaces another, one method displaces the previous one, and amidst this constant noise, common sense seems to have vanished.

This book stems precisely from that need to reclaim what is essential. It doesn't aim to offer magic formulas or instant solutions. It's not a manual for perfection, but an invitation to understand. To understand how our body works, what it truly needs, and why, despite knowing so much, we continue to act against our own nature.

Because the reality is that much of what we do daily isn't a conscious decision, but rather a matter of inertia. We eat at certain times not because we're hungry, but because it's "time." We sit for hours because our routine demands it. We sleep worse than we could because we've normalized habits that interfere with rest. And so, day after day, we repeat patterns without questioning them, as if they were an inevitable part of life.

Breaking that inertia isn't easy. It requires stopping, observing, and, in many cases, unlearning. It means questioning deeply ingrained beliefs, some passed down through generations, others adopted for convenience or due to social pressure. It means accepting that what's usual isn't always right, and that what's comfortable isn't always healthy.

Throughout these pages, we will explore a fundamental idea: health doesn't depend on a single action, but rather on the combination of multiple simple factors that, when aligned, generate a profound impact. It's not about extremes, but about balance. It's about understanding when to eat and when not to, when to move and when to rest, when to stimulate the body and when to allow it to recover. It's about, in a way, returning it to the environment for which it was designed.

We will talk about nutrition, yes, but not from an obsessive perspective of counting calories or following rigid rules, but rather from an understanding of the body's natural rhythms. We will talk about movement, not as an obligation, but as an inherent biological need. We will talk about rest, stress, light, time... all those elements that, although they may seem commonplace, have an enormous impact on how we live and how we age.

We will also debunk myths. Many of them accepted without question, repeated until they become unquestionable truths. Myths that, at times, distance us from what truly

benefits us. Because progress isn't always about adding more things, but about eliminating the unnecessary, simplifying, returning to the basics.

This isn't a book to change your life in a day. It's a book to help you start looking at it differently. To understand that small decisions, sustained over time, have enormous power. To remember that our bodies don't need us to force them, but rather to listen to them.

Ultimately, extending life shouldn't be the only goal. What truly matters is extending life with health, energy, and the ability to enjoy every stage. And that doesn't depend on a secret formula, but on something much more accessible: the will to step off autopilot and start living consciously.

Because, ultimately, it's not about doing more... but about doing better.

2. The problems of today's society

We live in an age of unprecedented abundance, a time when food has ceased to be an uncertain commodity and has become a constant, silent, and almost omnipresent commodity. We need only reach out, open a door, press a button, or walk a few meters to find food. Never before in all of human history has eating been so easy. And yet, therein lies one of the great paradoxes of our time.

Abundance, which in another context would have been a celebrated blessing, has transformed into a constant temptation. Food no longer arrives as a reward after effort, but as a permanent stimulus, available anytime, anywhere. We eat without hunger, out of habit, anxiety, boredom, or simple inertia. The body, designed to manage cycles of scarcity and satiety, is now trapped in an uninterrupted stream of intake that prevents it from remembering its natural rhythm.

This abundance is compounded by the gradual disappearance of the effort required to obtain it. There was a time when eating involved movement, ingenuity, and physical exertion. Today, however, energy comes to us with hardly any investment of our own. The chain that linked hunger, action, and reward has been broken. The act of eating has become detached from effort, and with it, an essential part of its meaning has been lost. The reward has ceased to be earned and has become automatic.

Meanwhile, the world of work has undergone a silent but profound transformation. Jobs that once demanded physical exertion have been gradually replaced by tasks that primarily require the mind—and often not even that entirely. Machines have taken over the burden of physical effort, freeing us from carrying loads, commuting, and manual labor. But this liberation, far from being absolute, has come at a hidden cost: the human body, deprived of its natural function, has fallen into a kind of lethargy.

We spend hours sitting motionless in front of screens that capture our attention but require no movement. Our days pass between chairs, keyboards, and meetings, while our bodies remain in the background, almost forgotten. Muscles, designed for action, weaken; metabolism, designed to adapt to exertion, slows down. And so, almost without realizing it, we drift further and further away from our own nature.

Added to all this is an intangible yet profoundly decisive factor: the stress of modern life. This stress no longer stems from the need to survive in a hostile environment, but from a complex web of work responsibilities, financial worries, social demands, and family challenges. It is a constant, sustained stress that rarely finds an outlet.

Before, tension found its release in action: running, hunting, fighting, moving. Today, however, it accumulates silently. It remains in the body, in the form of restlessness, mental fatigue, insomnia. And often, it seeks relief where it is easiest to find: in food, in consumption, in small, immediate pleasures that offer a momentary respite, but not a real solution.

Thus, abundance, lack of effort, sedentary lifestyles, and stress form a complex web that defines our way of life... and, to a large extent, how we become ill. These are not isolated elements, but pieces of the same puzzle that, when combined, create a lifestyle profoundly different from the one for which we were designed.

And yet, amidst all of this, a silent truth remains: our bodies are still the same. They haven't evolved at the pace of technology or society. They still crave movement, still understand hunger as a signal, still need pauses, effort, and balance. Perhaps the key lies not in rejecting the modern world, but in learning to reconcile ourselves with that ancestral part that still dwells within us, reminding us, with infinite patience, how to live in a way that is more in harmony with who we truly are.

2.1. Abuse of the digestive system

The human digestive system, at its deepest core, is an untouched legacy from our most distant ancestors. It hasn't been shaped by modern conveniences or constant abundance, but by an ancient world where uncertainty dictated the rhythm of life. For thousands upon thousands of years, humankind knew neither a full pantry nor a packed refrigerator; instead, it knew the silence of an empty stomach, the strain of effort, and the brief but intense fullness of the food it had obtained.

Our bodies are written in that ancient language. They weren't designed to receive food continuously, mechanically, and without pause, but to adapt to a natural, almost ritualistic cycle: absence, effort, and reward. First, hunger. That state we try to avoid at all costs today was, in reality, the starting point. Not as suffering, but as a signal, as a call. Hunger sharpened the senses, honed the mind, and awakened instinct. It was the engine that drove human beings to move, to explore, to take risks.

It's sad to say, but nowadays we eat in a completely programmed way and have lost the natural hunger signal. Our brain tells us to eat even when we're not really hungry, more out of habit than necessity.

2.2. Lack of exercise

If we compare ourselves to our ancestors, when they felt true hunger, they had no choice but to submit to movement, action, exercise in its purest form: going out to hunt. It wasn't planned training or a gym routine, but a total expression of the body in search of survival. Walking long distances, running, stalking, climbing, throwing... every muscle had a purpose, every heartbeat a meaning. Effort wasn't optional; it was the only path to life.

In modern society this is no longer the case, and we can obtain food with a caloric expenditure close to 0 in most cases .

Moreover, speaking not only of the physical exertion involved in obtaining food, but also of the physical exertion performed in our workplaces, we could say that the

history of humanity, to a large extent, can be read as the story of how we gradually shifted the burden of effort from our own muscles to the increasingly sophisticated hands of machines. With the arrival of the Industrial Revolution, this process accelerated decisively: what previously required entire days of intense physical labor began to be accomplished through gears, steam, electricity, and, later, automation. The countryside, the factory, transportation... all areas of life began to transform under the same logic: to do more with less human effort.

Initially, this change brought obvious relief. Extreme physical exertion was reduced, certain tasks were shortened, and many living conditions improved. However, a less visible but profoundly significant consequence also occurred, albeit quietly: the human body ceased to be essential for many of the tasks that had defined its function for millennia. What once demanded strength, endurance, and constant movement was replaced by levers, motors, and automated systems that performed the work without fatigue.

Over time, this transformation affected not only the most physically demanding jobs but extended to virtually all areas of work. The office replaced the workshop, the screen replaced manual labor, and the click replaced movement. Today, a large part of the population carries out their daily activities sitting down, with minimal energy expenditure. The body remains active in appearance—it breathes, stands upright, responds—but its actual involvement is minimal compared to that of our ancestors.

This change has a direct impact on calorie expenditure. Humans, designed for constant movement, have seen their daily energy expenditure significantly reduced. Where large amounts of energy were once burned simply to survive—hunting, gathering, building, traveling—today that expenditure must be consciously, almost artificially, sought through planned exercise. Movement has ceased to be a necessity and has become a choice.

The result is a progressive imbalance: we ingest more energy than we expend, not necessarily because we eat more than before in absolute terms, but because our body no longer consumes what it used to. External mechanisms have taken over the work, but our metabolism continues to wait for that level of activity that no longer arrives. And so, little by little, energy accumulates without an outlet, resulting in fatigue, weight gain, and a vague feeling of disconnection from our bodies.

Paradoxically, in our quest to make life easier, we have eliminated much of what kept us in balance. Industrialization has given us time, comfort, and efficiency, but it has also distanced us from the natural physical exertion that was an inseparable part of our biology. Today, more than ever, the challenge is not to produce more with less effort, but to remember that, somewhere within us, that effort is still necessary.

2.3. Unhealthy food

And finally, after the physical exertion, came the reward for our ancestors. Food wasn't immediate or guaranteed, but when it arrived, it did so with an intensity we can scarcely imagine today. Eating wasn't a trivial or automatic act; it was an almost sacred moment. The hunted prey was honored, shared, and celebrated. The body, after the effort, received the energy necessary to recover, strengthen itself, and prepare for the next cycle.

Fortunately for them, the hunted prey or the food they enjoyed was just that: food.

The difference between what our ancestors ate and what we find in supermarkets today is not just a matter of variety, but of essence. They fed on what the earth and nature offered in their purest form: wild animals that had lived freely, fruits picked at their peak ripeness, roots, seeds, and plants that had not been modified or processed. Each food had a story tied to the environment, the climate, and the season; nothing was constant, nothing was artificially prolonged. Today, however, we walk down aisles overflowing with products designed to last, to seduce, and to be consumed effortlessly: processed, refined foods, loaded with sugars, additives, and preservatives, created more in laboratories than in fields. What was once a direct relationship with nature has been transformed into an industry-mediated experience, where flavor is intensified, texture is modified, and availability is endless, but in that process, the true nutritional richness and the original bond between human beings and their food are often diluted.

Thus, food was not a continuous line, but a rhythm, a dance between scarcity and abundance. Hunger, movement, and satiety formed a perfect balance, deeply rooted in our biology. Today, however, we live in a constant disruption of that cycle: we eat without having felt hungry, we often ingest foods we shouldn't, without having expended energy, and we turn the reward into routine.

But somewhere, beneath layers of modern habits, our bodies still remember. They still await that ancient language. They still function, silently, as they always have: ready to alternate absence with effort, and effort with reward. Because, after all, we are not so different from those first humans who, driven by hunger and determination, ventured out into the world in search of their next meal... and found, in that process, much more than sustenance.

2.4. Stress and its impact on the body

The stress of modern life is not a fleeting noise or a passing storm; it is more like a constant drizzle that seeps in little by little, almost imperceptibly, until it soaks into every corner of daily life. It no longer stems solely from visible or immediate threats, as in ancient times, but from a complex array of worries: work responsibilities that don't end when you leave the office, family demands that require your presence and attention, financial uncertainties that weigh like a persistent shadow, and fears related to your own health or the health of those around you. It is a silent, sustained stress that is rarely completely relieved.

The human body, however, doesn't distinguish between real danger and constant worry. It responds in the same way: by activating alert mechanisms that were originally designed for brief, specific situations. Hormones like cortisol and adrenaline are released to prepare us for action, to flee or fight. But when this state persists, when there is no clear resolution or genuine rest, the body enters a kind of permanent tension that begins to erode its most delicate functions.

One of the first areas to suffer is sex life. Desire, far from being an automatic impulse, is a phenomenon deeply sensitive to physical and emotional state. For it to exist, the body needs to feel safe, relaxed, and available. But stress works in the opposite way: it prioritizes survival over pleasure, urgency over connection. The mind, preoccupied with worries, loses space for desire; the body, tense, reduces its responsiveness. Little by little, intimacy becomes secondary, displaced by tiredness, anxiety, or lack of energy.

Furthermore, the hormonal system itself is disrupted. Excess cortisol can interfere with the production of sex hormones, affecting both desire and performance. In men, this can lead to decreased testosterone; in women, to imbalances that affect the menstrual cycle and libido. But beyond the physiological aspects, there is a key emotional component: disconnection. When the mind is constantly occupied, it becomes difficult to be present, and without presence, intimacy loses its depth.

Simultaneously, sleep—that fundamental pillar of health—begins to fragment. Sleep is not simply closing your eyes; it is a complex process in which the body repairs itself, the brain organizes information, and the nervous system finds equilibrium. However, stress introduces constant interference into this process. The mind, unable to switch off, remains active even in darkness. Thoughts that were relegated to the background during the day resurface with force: to-do lists, worries, hypothetical scenarios.

Falling asleep then becomes a challenge. The body is tired, but not relaxed; the mind is exhausted, but not calm. And when sleep is finally achieved, the quality of rest is not always deep. Nighttime awakenings, light sleep, or the feeling of not having rested upon waking are manifestations of that state of alertness that refuses to switch off.

This sleep deficit, in turn, exacerbates the problem. Insufficient rest affects mood, increases irritability, reduces the ability to manage stress, and disrupts hormonal balance. This creates a vicious cycle: stress prevents good sleep, and lack of sleep increases stress.

In this context, both sex life and sleep cease to be natural and spontaneous aspects and become sensitive indicators of our internal state. They are like silent thermometers that reflect the level of balance—or imbalance—in which we live. When stress dominates, both suffer; when the body and mind find spaces of calm, they tend to restore themselves.

The paradox of modern life is that, despite having more comforts and advancements than ever before, we have created an environment in which rest and pleasure—two of the most essential functions of human beings—are constantly threatened. Recovering them doesn't necessarily mean eliminating all sources of stress, something almost impossible, but rather learning to create genuine spaces for disconnection, moments in which the body can abandon its state of alert and remember what it feels like to be calm.

Because, ultimately, sleep and intimacy are not luxuries or extras: they are deep needs, mechanisms of equilibrium that the body insistently demands. And perhaps, amidst the accelerated pace of modern life, heeding that call is one of the most important—and most forgotten—acts for preserving health.

2.5. mTOR pandemic

The reader has probably never heard this term before, since we are coining it right now, but perhaps to understand what this pandemic entails, we should explain what we mean by mTOR

<u>What is mTOR ?</u>

Deep within our cells, beyond the reach of our senses, a constant, silent, and crucial conversation for our health takes place. It's not a conversation of words, but of chemical signals that tell the body what to do at any given moment: grow, repair, store energy... or, conversely, conserve, recycle, and protect itself. Among these signals, two major metabolic “conductors” stand out. Although we don't see or feel them directly, they greatly influence how we age and how we become ill: the pathways known as AMPK and mTOR .

We can imagine these two pathways as two sides of the same coin, two complementary forces seeking balance. On one hand, AMPK acts as an energy sensor, a kind of guardian that activates when the body detects limited resources. On the other, mTOR is the great driver of growth, the one that kicks in when there is abundance and the organism can afford to build, multiply, and expand.

When we talk about AMPK, we're talking about a signal that activates in situations that, from an evolutionary perspective, were commonplace: fasting, exercise, scarcity. It's the pathway that says: "There isn't enough energy; we need to optimize, repair, eliminate what's no longer needed, and maintain what's essential." Under its influence, the body improves its efficiency, promotes fat burning, activates cellular recycling processes (like autophagy), and protects against wear and tear. It's, in a way, a pathway associated with intelligent survival.

mTOR , on the other hand, conveys the opposite message: “There is plenty, it’s time to grow.” When this pathway is activated—especially by the presence of nutrients, particularly proteins and certain amino acids, as well as insulin—the body enters building mode. Proteins are synthesized, cells divide, and tissues grow. It is a fundamental pathway for the development, regeneration, and maintenance of muscle mass. Without mTOR , we could neither grow nor recover.

So far, both seem essential, and they are. The problem lies not in their existence, but in the imbalance between them.

For most of human history, these two pathways alternated naturally. There were periods of scarcity (which activated AMPK) and periods of abundance (which activated mTOR). The body was prepared for this ebb and flow, for this rhythm. However, in modern life, this balance has been profoundly disrupted.

mTOR activation . We eat several times a day, often without having depleted our energy reserves; we continuously consume high-calorie, high-protein foods; we rarely experience prolonged fasting; and physical exercise, which would activate AMPK, is often scarce. The result is that the body receives the message to “grow, build, multiply” almost constantly.

In the short term, this may seem positive. But in the long term, the story changes.

mTOR activation means that cells are constantly stimulated to grow and divide. This sustained growth can become a problem when fine-tuning these processes is lost. Under normal conditions, the body has mechanisms to detect errors, repair damage, or eliminate defective cells. But when the growth signal is too persistent, these mechanisms can become overwhelmed.

This is where its relationship with degenerative and cancerous diseases comes in.

In the case of cancer, the link is especially clear. Cancer, in essence, is uncontrolled cell growth. And mTOR is precisely one of the pathways that promotes growth. When this pathway is overactivated , it can allow cells with mutations—which under other circumstances would have been eliminated—to continue growing and multiplying. It is not the only cause of cancer, of course, but it is a factor that can contribute to creating an environment conducive to its development.

Regarding degenerative diseases, the mechanism is more subtle, but equally important. The body periodically needs to activate internal cleaning processes, eliminating damaged or aged cellular components. This process, known as autophagy, is closely linked to the activation of AMPK and, to some extent, inhibited by mTOR . When mTOR is constantly active, this "cleaning" is reduced. It's as if a house keeps expanding and being decorated without ever taking out the trash.

Over time, this accumulation of cellular "waste" can contribute to the deterioration of tissues and organs, favoring age-related diseases such as neurodegenerative, metabolic, or cardiovascular problems.

The key, therefore, is not in eliminating mTOR or living permanently in AMPK mode, but in restoring the natural balance between both pathways. The body needs periods of growth, but also periods of repair. It needs nourishment, but also rest from food. It needs activity, but also recovery.

Practices such as physical exercise, periods of fasting, or simply spacing out meals can promote the activation of AMPK, restoring some of the body's lost balance. Similarly, a proper diet allows mTOR to perform its function in a controlled manner, without leading to constant stimulation.

Ultimately, these two paths remind us of something profoundly simple yet often forgotten: health is not a static state, but a dynamic equilibrium. It's not about always doing the same thing, but about alternating, listening, and respecting the rhythms for which we were designed.

Because, although the world has changed radically, our cells continue to function under the same old rules. And in that invisible dialogue between AMPK and mTOR , the quality and length of our lives largely depend.

<u>And why do we say it's a pandemic?</u>

Looking back at human history, major pandemics have always had something in common: they erupt visibly, generate alarm, collapse systems, and force a response. The Black Death, for example, wiped out entire populations in a matter of years; the Spanish Flu spread with devastating speed in a world that was just beginning to globalize; even the recent COVID-19 brought the planet to a standstill

and highlighted our collective vulnerability. All of them had a face, evident symptoms, daily figures, and a clear narrative of threat. However, what we might call the “ mTOR pandemic ” is of a radically different nature: it is not transmitted through the air or by contact, it does not present with fever or cough, it does not force lockdowns or immediately overwhelm hospitals... and yet, it advances much more silently, steadily, and globally.

Unlike pandemics that arrived like a violent storm, chronic activation of the mTOR pathway is more like a slow, rising tide that barely registers. It doesn't kill in days or weeks, but rather erodes over years, even decades. It has no clear beginning or end because it doesn't depend on an identifiable external agent, but on a lifestyle shared by millions: eating continuously, moving little, living in a near-permanent state of energy abundance. It's a pandemic without urgent headlines, without infection maps, without daily press conferences. And precisely for that reason, it's more difficult to perceive... and to combat.

While classic pandemics forced humanity into isolation, reduced contact, and protection from the outside world, this new pandemic, paradoxically, arises from our own everyday environment. It is not something that attacks us from the outside, but something we activate from within, every day, almost without realizing it. It doesn't generate immediate fear, but rather a false sense of normalcy. And yet, its consequences are deeply linked to many of the diseases that currently dominate mortality statistics: cancer, degenerative diseases, and metabolic disorders.

Another key difference is the perception of time. Historical pandemics were urgent: they demanded rapid responses, drastic measures, and immediate solutions. The “ mTOR pandemic ,” on the other hand, unfolds at a slow, almost imperceptible pace. Its effects are not linked to a specific cause from the previous day, but rather to an accumulation of habits over the years. This makes raising awareness extremely difficult, because humans are much better equipped to react to visible threats than to diffuse processes.

And yet, there is a profound similarity among them all: their collective nature. Just as viruses spread by exploiting interaction between people, this constant activation of mTOR extends through a shared lifestyle: the constant availability of food, widespread sedentary behavior, and a culture of immediacy. It is a cultural pandemic, almost invisible, but as global as any that have marked history.

Perhaps the greatest paradox is that, while past pandemics spurred advances in hygiene, medicine, and social organization, this new pandemic requires something different: not so much additional technology, but a conscious return to certain basic principles. It is not fought with vaccines or antibiotics, but with everyday decisions that rebalance the body's internal functioning.

Because, in the end, the “ mTOR pandemic ” isn't an external enemy we can point the finger at, but a reflection of how we live. And perhaps for that very reason, even though it's quieter and less spectacular than the great health crises in history, its impact can be just as profound... or even greater, precisely because it advances silently.

2.6. Life expectancy

When we compare the life expectancy of our ancestors with that of today, the first impression is clear and compelling: we live longer now. The figures confirm this unequivocally. Where in ancient times reaching advanced age was an almost legendary exception, in the modern world it has become commonplace. However, beneath this apparent truth lies a more complex reality, one that invites us to look beyond the numbers and ask not only how long we live, but how we live.

Our ancestors inhabited a hostile, unpredictable world where life often hung by a thread. There were no antibiotics, no vaccines, no advanced surgery. A minor infection could become a death sentence, a poorly healed wound could end a life, and diseases we now consider treatable were then fatal. Added to this was an environment in which humans didn't always occupy the top of the food chain: predators, the climate, scarcity of resources—everything conspired to shorten life. It wasn't that their bodies were more fragile, but rather that the circumstances were relentless.

Today, however, we have managed to tame many of those risks. Thanks to advances in medicine, we have learned to prevent, diagnose, and treat diseases that were once unavoidable. Hygiene, technology, scientific knowledge, and social organization have built a safety net that allows us to survive situations that would have been lethal in the past. We no longer live in constant fear of being hunted, nor do we depend solely on luck to overcome illness. In this sense, humanity has achieved one of its greatest victories: prolonging life.

But prolonging life doesn't always mean living healthier in absolute terms. This is where the comparison becomes more interesting, almost paradoxical. Because, although our ancestors lived fewer years, their bodies were deeply adapted to their environment. They were constantly moving, they ate real, unprocessed food, and they unknowingly respected the natural cycles of hunger and satiety, of activity and rest. Their physiology functioned in harmony with their lifestyle.

We, on the other hand, have created an environment that protects life, but that often challenges the body's natural balance. We live longer, yes, but we also live longer with chronic illnesses, with metabolic imbalances, with a slow decline that doesn't always manifest immediately, but accompanies many for decades. It's as if we've won the battle against premature death, but at the same time opened the door to new, more silent forms of frailty.

It is not, therefore, a matter of idealizing the past or rejecting the present. Our ancestors, if they could choose, would not hesitate to embrace the advances of modern medicine, the security of not being prey, the peace of mind of knowing that an illness is not necessarily the end. For them, all of that would be nothing short of miraculous. Likewise, we, if we look honestly, would recognize the value of their lifestyle: constant movement, connection with nature, simple and wholesome food, respect for biological rhythms.

Ultimately, each era possesses something the other longs for. They would like our protection; we, their balance.

And perhaps therein lies the key, in that kind of meeting point between two worlds. Because the combination of both—the security and knowledge of the present, along with the instinctive wisdom of the past—creates a profoundly human ideal. A way of life in which medicine protects us when necessary, but in which daily life is built on habits that honor the nature for which we were designed.

3. What is the NEXUS method? The 5 Pillars

Perhaps it's not about choosing between past and present, but about reconciling them. About living in a modern world without forgetting who we are at our core. About taking advantage of the advancements that allow us to live longer... but learning, at the same time, to live better. Because, in the end, true wealth lies not just in adding years to life, but in adding life to those years.

The NEXUS method is a comprehensive and systemic approach designed to optimize health, energy, and longevity by connecting five essential biological systems that work together to promote healthy aging. Its name is an acronym where each letter represents a fundamental pillar of human physiology: Nutrition , Exercise , Expression , Unwind , and Stress Adaptation .

The fundamental goal of this method is to "stretch life," ensuring that the additional years are of high quality by improving metabolic, cognitive, and hormonal health.

The NEXUS method is defined as the point of convergence where past habits and modern society meet to create sustainable health. It is not a list of isolated habits, but a coherent, science-based lifestyle model.

The following details what each pillar consists of and what the purpose of this method is:

3.1. Nutrition : The Real Food Revolution

3.1.1. An everyday scene (and a modern problem)

You walk into any supermarket. Entire aisles are filled with ready-to-open, heat-up, or eat products: snacks, sugary drinks, "fitness" cereals, "protein" bars, and prepared meals. This selection is not random: it reflects a food model where convenience, palatability, and long shelf life have become dominant criteria.

Epidemiological evidence suggests that, in many high-income countries, a very significant portion of dietary energy comes from ultra-processed foods ; for example, the British Medical Journal (BMJ) reports approximate ranges of 42% to 58% depending on the country (Australia vs. USA), reflecting an increasingly industrialized dietary pattern.

In this context, real fooding emerges : an approach that proposes to recover the prominence of recognizable foods — those that resemble what they were before entering a factory — and reduce dependence on industrial formulations designed primarily to be highly consumable.

3.1.2. What is real fooding (and what it isn't)

Real fooding can be understood as a food philosophy oriented towards:

- Prioritize real or minimally processed foods,
- Reduce your consumption of ultra-processed foods .
- Learn to interpret labels, and
- Strengthening home cooking as a tool for control and health.

Unlike a "diet" with a limited duration and fixed menus, this approach is presented as a framework for decisions: what to buy, how to cook, and what to eat regularly. This difference is crucial because the goal is not just to change body weight in weeks, but to improve the overall quality of the diet and its long-term sustainability.

Important note: Real fooding does not equate to “all processed food is bad.” In fact, institutions and technical reviews insist that “processed” is a very broad term and, on its own, of little use if the type, degree, and purpose of processing are not distinguished.

3.1.3. The language of real food: the NOVA classification as a practical map

To explain precisely what is being avoided (and why), real fooding often relies—explicitly or implicitly—on the NOVA classification, which groups foods according to the degree and purpose of industrial processing.

Group 1 - Unprocessed or minimally processed foods

It includes edible parts of plants and animals, and foods modified with basic techniques (washing, refrigeration, freezing, pasteurization, non-alcoholic fermentation, etc.) that seek safety, preservation and ease of preparation, without substantially altering the nature of the food.

Examples: fruits and vegetables, dried or plain cooked legumes, eggs, fish, fresh meat, milk, plain unsweetened yogurt, "plain" whole grain cereals, nuts, water, coffee or unsweetened infusions.

Group 2 - Processed culinary ingredients

They are substances extracted or refined from group 1 foods (oils, sugar, salt) for cooking and seasoning; they are rarely consumed alone.

Group 3 - Processed Foods

Here, processing aims to increase shelf life or improve sensory qualities by adding salt, sugar, or oil to foods in group 1 (e.g., preserves, traditional bread, plain cheeses). They maintain a recognizable identity and usually have 2–3 ingredients.

Group 4 - Ultra-processed foods

These are industrial formulations made primarily with food-derived substances (starches, refined oils, sugars, protein isolates) and additives (emulsifiers, colorings, flavors, enhancers) to maximize texture, flavor, appearance and shelf life, with little or no presence of "whole food".

Furthermore, technical reports highlight that their design makes them very convenient (“ready to eat”) and frequently hyperpalatable , encouraging repeated consumption.

3.1.4. The real fooding thesis : why quality matters more than calorie counting

Real food emphasizes a point that contemporary nutrition has had to relearn: not all calories behave the same way in the body and in our behavior. Whole foods, rich in fiber and water, tend to promote satiety; in contrast, many ultra-processed foods concentrate energy and minimize physiological signals of restraint, encouraging overeating.

This idea is not based solely on intuition: there is experimental evidence suggesting that, even when macronutrients and calories are equal, an ultra-processed diet can induce greater spontaneous energy expenditure.

3.1.5. What science says: epidemiological evidence and controlled trials

Observational evidence (associations)

umbrella review A review published in the BMJ in 2024 evaluated epidemiological meta-analyses (up to June 2023) and found direct associations between greater exposure to ultra-processed foods and multiple adverse outcomes, especially cardiometabolic , mental health and mortality.

In that review, the association with type 2 diabetes in dose-response analysis (RR ≈ 1.12) and with cardiovascular mortality (RR ≈ 1.50) was classified as “convincing” (according to predefined credibility criteria), although the GRADE quality varied and not all results achieved high robustness.

Additionally, a more recent dose-response meta-analysis (2025) with 18 cohorts (≈ 1.15 million participants) estimated a 15% higher risk of all-cause mortality when comparing higher vs. lower consumption of ultra-processed foods (HR ≈ 1.15), and a 10% higher risk for each 10% increase in consumption (HR ≈ 1.10), highlighting that the body of evidence continues to show heterogeneity.

These observational data are consistent, but do not "prove" causality on their own; they inform population risk and guide mechanistic hypotheses .

Experimental evidence (short-term causality)

National randomized controlled trial. Institutes of Health (NIH) published in Cell Metabolism , where participants received a mostly ultra-processed diet for two weeks and a minimally processed diet for another two weeks.

Even though the diets were designed to be comparable in calories and macronutrients offered, people ate ~500 kcal/day more with the ultra-processed diet , ate faster and gained weight (≈ 0.9 kg), while with the minimally processed diet, weight loss of a similar magnitude occurred.

This type of evidence is especially relevant to real fooding because it suggests a behavioral-physiological mechanism: the food environment and the nature of the food can modify intake without the need for "lack of willpower".

3.1.6. Plausible mechanisms: from sensory "hyperstimulation " to the biology of satiety

Current science does not attribute the effects of ultra-processed foods to a single cause, but to a set of properties: texture, energy density, speed of consumption, altered food matrix, additives, packaging, and sugar/salt/fat profiles.

Hyperpalatability and reward system

hyperpalatable foods can stimulate reward circuits and modulate hormonal signals linked to appetite and satiety (dopamine, leptin, ghrelin , among others), promoting cravings and repeated consumption.

In parallel, technical documents on ultra-processed foods highlight the role of "cosmetic" additives (flavors, colors, emulsifiers) and formulations that mimic sensory qualities of real foods, increasing appeal and convenience.

Real fooding does not demonize the pleasure of eating; it questions an industrial design that "optimizes" pleasure to make it more likely to overeat, more often.

Food matrix, fiber and satiety

Diets based on minimally processed foods tend to increase fiber and water density, and with it satiety; conversely, many ultra-processed foods tend to be lower in fiber and facilitate quick intake.

The BMJ review itself points to matrix alterations, poor nutritional profile and possible impacts on microbiota and inflammation as emerging mechanistic lines, although it insists that mechanistic research is still under development.

Microbiota, gut and signaling (including serotonin)

The relationship between diet, gut microbiota, and neuroendocrine signaling is an active area of research. A classic experimental study showed that certain gut bacteria can modulate serotonin biosynthesis from enteroendocrine cells in the colon, with effects on gastrointestinal physiology and other systems.

Recent reviews discuss how the microbiota can influence serotonin metabolism and how this signaling is involved in the regulation of metabolic processes and gut-organ communication.

Practical translation: Increasing the consumption of fiber-rich and minimally processed foods is generally consistent with microbiota support strategies, although the exact causal relationship, the magnitude of the effect, and its individual clinical translation are still under study.

3.1.7. Operating principles of real fooding (for real life)

In practical terms, real fooding is usually organized into five master habits:

Base of the dish: Group 1 (and part of 3)

Build the diet around unprocessed or minimally processed foods, and use simple processed foods as support (e.g., canned legumes or fish, frozen foods without sauces, traditional bread with simple ingredients).

Reducing ultra-processed foods without absolutes (but with intention)

The literature shows consistent associations between greater exposure to ultra-processed foods and worse health outcomes, although with variations by outcome and quality of evidence; therefore, the practical recommendation is usually to reduce them markedly.

Learn to read labels (ingredients first)

The ingredient list, its length, and the presence of functional/cosmetic additives help identify the degree of processing; moreover, the very concept of "processed" is ambiguous and requires looking at degree and purpose, not just "if it comes in a package".

Cooking as an act of public... and personal health

Cooking reduces reliance on ready-to-eat products and makes it easier to adjust salt, sugar, and fat intake, as well as restoring dietary variety. This argument aligns with the NOVA framework, where the problem is not cooking with ingredients (group 2), but rather replacing meals with ultra-processed products .

Not all ultra-processed foods are the same: criteria and context

It is important to clarify here: critical reviews point to heterogeneity within the " ultra-processed " group and warn that a binary classification may overlook nutritional differences, fortification, and social uses.

In other words: real fooding works better as a compass than as a dogma.

3.1.8. Expected benefits (and how to interpret them rigorously)

When a person consistently replaces part of their ultra-processed diet with real food, it is common to observe an improvement in dietary quality: more fiber, more micronutrients, less free liquid sugars, and less "easy" energy density.

At the population level, the aggregate evidence links higher consumption of ultra-processed foods with a higher risk of cardiometabolic outcomes and mortality, although not all results have the same level of certainty and more mechanistic research is needed .

At a short-term causal level, the NIH trial suggests that an ultra-processed diet can increase spontaneous intake and body weight within weeks, reinforcing the behavioral logic of real fooding .

3.1.9. Summary: a mature definition of “normal eating”

Ultimately, real fooding proposes something radical because it is obvious: eating foods that don't need an engineering department to exist.

It doesn't promise perfection, but direction. It doesn't demand purity, but clarity: that the everyday be real food, and that the exceptional—if it appears—be understood for what it is. And that idea, sustained over time, can be one of the most effective changes for improving metabolic health and our relationship with food in an environment that pushes us in the exact opposite direction.

3.2. Exercise : Muscle as life insurance

3.2.1. Strength as a forgotten capacity

For decades, heavy weight training was associated almost exclusively with bodybuilding or elite sports. In the collective imagination, lifting heavy weights was perceived as unnecessary, dangerous, or reserved for a select few. However, scientific research in recent decades has redefined this paradigm: strength is a central biological capacity for health, performance, and functional aging.

Heavy weight training is one of the most effective ways to develop this capacity. It's not simply about lifting heavy weights, but about applying sufficient mechanical and neuromuscular stimulation to trigger profound adaptations in the body: muscular, skeletal, metabolic, and neural.

3.2.2. What do we mean by “heavy loads”?

Heavy weight training is a type of strength training that uses weights that are high relative to an individual's maximum capacity. Technically, it is usually expressed as a percentage of 1RM (one -repetition maximum) . maximum), that is, the greatest weight that a person can move once with good technique.

Generally speaking, heavy loads are considered to be those approximately above 70–80% of 1RM, although this threshold can vary depending on the exercise, the individual's experience, and the training goal. The *American College of Sports Medicine (ACSM)* has stated for years that optimal development of maximal strength in healthy adults requires moderately -heavy to heavy loads, with individualized progressions and proper technique.

Unlike training with light loads and very high repetitions, heavy work is characterized by:

- High mechanical stress
- Increased demand on the central nervous system
- Fewer repetitions per set
- Greater technical and motor control requirements
- Greater importance of rest and recovery

Therefore, heavy training is not the same as reckless training. Its effectiveness depends on structure, progression, and technical skill.

3.2.3. The relative nature of weight

A key aspect of heavy weight training is its relative nature. It is not the object that defines the load, but the effort it requires from the individual.

A 20 kg dumbbell might seem trivial to an advanced lifter but extremely challenging to a beginner. Therefore, the concept of "heavy" should always be interpreted in relation to individual ability, not absolute values.

From this perspective, heavy training can be done with:

- Free weights (barbells, dumbbells, kettlebells)
- Guided machines
- Pulleys
- Sleds or external resistances
- Body weight itself, when the difficulty is high enough

3.2.4. Structural exercises and systemic response

In practice, heavy weight training usually relies on multi-joint exercises that allow the mobilization of large muscle masses and generate a powerful systemic response:

- Squats
- Dead weight
- Bench press
- Military Press
- Rowing
- Weighted pull-ups
- Hip thrust
- Heavy strides

These movements not only stimulate isolated muscles, but complete movement patterns, amplifying their impact on the neuromuscular system.

3.2.5. How the body responds: physiological mechanisms

Mechanical tension as a primary signal

Mechanical tension is one of the main stimuli for muscle adaptation. Heavy loads force the muscle to generate high levels of force, activating molecular pathways associated with both improved performance and increased muscle mass.

Recruitment of motor units

High loads require the recruitment of a greater number of motor units, including fast-twitch (type II) fibers, which have a greater potential to produce force and power. This phenomenon is central to improving maximum strength.

Adaptations of the nervous system

Heavy training generates particularly marked neural adaptations:

- Greater capacity to activate fibers simultaneously
- Improved intra- and intermuscular coordination
- Faster recruitment
- Improved technical efficiency under high voltage

These adaptations explain why the first strength improvements in beginners are due more to the nervous system than to muscle growth.

3.2.6. Main benefits of heavy weight training

Increased maximum strength

The scientific evidence is consistent: heavy loads generate greater improvements in maximum strength than light loads, especially when assessed by 1RM tests.

Meta-analyses and systematic reviews show that, when volume is comparable, protocols with high loads produce greater increases in maximum dynamic strength compared to very light loads.

Muscle hypertrophy

Contrary to popular belief, heavy weight training also induces muscle hypertrophy. Current research indicates that:

- Hypertrophy can be achieved with a wide range of loads
- The determining factor is effective effort
- Heavy loads generate hypertrophy while optimizing strength gains

Comparative studies show that muscle growth can be similar between high and low loads when training near failure, but high loads clearly outweigh strength improvements.

Improvement of bone mineral density

Bone is a dynamic tissue that responds to mechanical load. Heavy weight training provides osteogenic stimuli that promote bone remodeling.

Institutions such as the Mayo Clinic and clinical guidelines agree that strength training, especially when it includes high and progressive loads, contributes to:

- Prevent osteopenia
- Reduce the risk of osteoporosis
- Increase bone strength
- Reduce the risk of fractures

Improved body composition

Heavy work promotes the maintenance or increase of muscle mass and, combined with a proper diet, improves the ratio between lean mass and body fat.

Muscle not only provides strength, but is also a metabolically active tissue, associated with:

- Higher basal energy expenditure
- Better long-term weight control
- Functional physical appearance

Metabolism and insulin sensitivity

Several studies show that strength training improves insulin sensitivity and glucose management, even without drastic changes in body weight.

An increase in functional muscle mass enhances the body's ability to:

- Store glycogen
- Use glucose efficiently
- Reduce the risk of insulin resistance

This makes heavy weight training a relevant tool within metabolic prevention strategies.

Joint health and stability

Far from “wearing down” the joints, well-executed heavy training strengthens the structures that protect them:

- Stabilizing muscles
- Connective tissues
- Motor control

Mayo Clinic emphasizes that the benefits are clear when technique and progression are adequate, and that the risk appears mainly with poor execution or poorly managed loads.

3.2.7. Functionality and healthy aging

Strength is one of the best predictors of functional independence with age. In adults and older adults, training with relatively heavy loads—adapted to their capacity—helps combat:

- Sarcopenia
- Fragility
- Loss of balance
- Risk of falls
- Progressive dependence

Therefore, it is now considered a central tool for active aging, not an optional practice.

3.2.8. Nervous system and overall performance

Strength depends not only on muscle, but also on how the nervous system coordinates movement. Heavy weight training optimizes:

- Intra- and intermuscular coordination
- Activation speed
- Rapid force production
- On-demand body control

These adaptations benefit both people seeking health and athletes who need power, stability, and motor efficiency.

3.2.9. Summary: strength as an expression of adaptation

Heavy weight training is not a fad or a cultural imposition of fitness. It is a direct expression of human adaptive biology: the body gets stronger when it is challenged to be so.

Training hard, intelligently, and with respect for the process doesn't just build muscle. It builds resilience, autonomy, metabolic stability, and functional capacity for real life.

NEXUS understands muscle not as an aesthetic system, but as the largest endocrine organ in the body.

3.3. Vitality (eXpression): Sexual health as a biomarker

3.3.1. Sexuality beyond the act

Talking about an active sex life is not about counting encounters or measuring performance. From a contemporary health perspective, sexuality is understood as an essential dimension of human well-being, integrating physical, emotional, relational, and social components.

There is no single "correct" or universally healthy frequency of sexual activity. The experience of an active sex life varies widely depending on age, health status, life circumstances, whether or not one has a partner, sexual orientation, desire, previous experiences, and cultural context. Therefore, an active sex life is best defined not by the number of encounters, but by the degree to which sexuality is experienced in a satisfying, safe, and aligned way with one's own desires and boundaries.

Both the National Health Service (NHS) and the World Health Organization (WHO) emphasize that sexual health is part of overall health and is not limited to the absence of disease, but includes physical, emotional, mental and relational well-being in relation to sexuality.

3.3.2. What does “active sex life” really mean?

From a broad and inclusive perspective, an active sex life can incorporate multiple forms of sexual expression:

- Penetrative sexual intercourse
- Oral sex
- Intimate caresses and erotic contact
- Kisses and physical affection
- Individual or shared masturbation
- Consensual sex games
- Bodily and emotional intimacy

Reducing sexuality solely to intercourse is not only inaccurate, but it also obscures many legitimate forms of pleasure, connection, and well-being. The literature on sexual health and well-being insists that healthy sexuality is not defined by a specific practice, but rather by the subjective experience of satisfaction, safety, and consent.

Furthermore, an active sex life doesn't necessarily require a stable partner. It can be experienced through consensual relationships, casual encounters, self-exploration, or an intimate life centered on affection and physical contact. What matters from a health perspective isn't the relationship structure, but rather that sexuality contributes to well-being and doesn't cause physical or emotional harm.

3.3.3. Basic principles of healthy sexuality

When discussing an active sex life in terms of health, there are some cross-cutting principles that consistently appear in clinical guidelines and public health frameworks:

- Free and explicit consent
- Mutual respect
- Absence of coercion or violence
- Physical and emotional security
- Mutual desire and agreement (when there is a couple)

The WHO emphasizes that the possibility of pleasurable and safe sexual experiences, free from discrimination and violence, is a central requirement of sexual health.

3.3.4. What happens in the body during sexual activity

Sexual activity involves an integrated response of multiple body systems, which goes far beyond the reproductive system.

Cardiovascular response

During arousal and orgasm, the following occur:

- Increased heart rate
- Increased blood flow
- General circulatory activation
- Mild to moderate physical exertion in many people

Harvard Health and the American Heart Association describe sexual activity, in most situations, as a form of light to -moderate intensity physical activity, comparable to climbing stairs or brisk walking, but not a substitute for structured exercise.

Hormonal and neurological response

During sexual activity, and especially after orgasm, various substances related to pleasure and emotional regulation are released:

- Dopamine, associated with pleasure and motivation
- Oxytocin, linked to attachment, relaxation and bonding
- Endorphins, with analgesic and euphoric effects

Cleveland Clinic explains that the release of oxytocin and endorphins after orgasm is associated with relaxation, improved mood, and, in some people, easier sleep.

Muscle activation and body control

Sexual activity involves:

- Activation of the trunk, pelvis and limbs
- Involuntary muscle contractions during orgasm
- Participation of the pelvic floor muscles in certain contexts

This bodily component contributes to making sexuality not only an emotional experience, but also an integrated physical experience.

Emotional and psychological dimension

From a psychological point of view, sexual activity can:

- To foster emotional connection
- Temporarily reduce the perception of stress
- Increase the feeling of intimacy and closeness
- To generate states of relaxation and satisfaction

3.3.5. Main benefits of an active sex life

Emotional well-being and mood

It is well known that these effects occur in the body after sexual activity:

- Feeling of relaxation
- Reduction of emotional tension
- Greater subjective well-being
- Increased emotional closeness

These effects are related to the release of neurotransmitters involved in pleasure and attachment. The Cleveland Clinic notes that these responses may contribute to improving mood in some people, although they should not be interpreted as psychological treatment.

Observational studies with adults and older people have shown that those who report recent sexual activity tend to have higher levels of enjoyment of life, although this does not necessarily imply a direct causal relationship.

Stress reduction and relaxation

After orgasm, many people describe a feeling of physical and mental release. The Cleveland Clinic indicates that sexual activity can, in some cases, help normalize cortisol levels and promote relaxation.

It is important to emphasize that sex **is not a therapy for psychological disorders** , but it can be part of a lifestyle that helps to better manage everyday stress.

Improved sleep

One of the most consistent effects is improved sleep after orgasm, related to:

- Muscle relaxation
- Oxytocin and prolactin release
- Decreased state of alertness

Cleveland Clinic and Harvard Health agree that these neurohormonal changes can facilitate rest in some people.

Physical activity and cardiovascular health

Although it does not replace exercise, sexual activity can provide:

- Mild cardiovascular stimulation
- Moderate energy consumption
- General muscle activation

Harvard Health notes that the average exertion of sex is usually within safe ranges for most healthy people and many with stable cardiovascular disease, provided there is individual adaptation.

Couple bond and intimacy

In consensual relationships, a satisfying sex life can help:

- Strengthen the emotional connection
- Improve body language
- Increase emotional closeness
- Maintaining desire and complicity

The literature on relational sexuality highlights that sexuality can act as a form of expression of affection and bonding, although it is not the only pillar of a healthy relationship.

3.3.6. Specific physical benefits

Pelvic floor

In some people, regular sexual activity is associated with increased activation and awareness of the pelvic floor, which may contribute to:

- Better sexual response
- Greater comfort in intimacy
- Improved muscle control in specific contexts

Cleveland Clinic notes that, in certain cases, sexual activity can contribute to the functional maintenance of the pelvic floor, provided there is no pain.

Temporary pain relief

Endorphins released during orgasm can act as natural painkillers. Some people describe temporary relief from:

- Headaches
- Muscle tension
- Minor physical discomfort

Cleveland Clinic acknowledges this effect in certain individuals, but it does not replace medical evaluation.

Sexual function and self-knowledge

Maintaining an active sex life can benefit:

- Greater awareness of one's own body
- Identifying desire and arousal
- Trust in intimacy
- Greater sexual satisfaction

According to the Cleveland Clinic, masturbation is a normal and healthy form of sexual exploration, associated in some people with stress reduction, improved mood, and better sleep.

3.3.7. Self-esteem, identity and aging

A fulfilling sex life can positively influence self-esteem, body image, and self-confidence. Mayo Clinic highlights that, in older adults, maintaining sexual interest and enjoyment of intimacy is associated with good health and well-being in later life.

This does not imply that personal worth depends on sexual activity, but rather that sexuality can be a legitimate source of well-being at any age, when it is lived with respect and adaptation to the changes in the body.

3.3.8. Summary: Sexuality as a dimension of health

Having an active sex life is not an obligation or a marker of "normality." It is a human possibility that, when lived consciously, consensually, and in alignment with one's own needs, can contribute to physical, emotional, and relational well-being.

From a health perspective, the goal is not to prescribe how much or how, but to recognize sexuality as a legitimate dimension of comprehensive health, as worthy of care as exercise, nutrition, or rest.

3.4. Recovery (Unwind): The biological mandate of sleep

3.4.1. Sleeping is not disconnecting, it's working

Sleep is often perceived as a passive state, almost as a shutdown of the body. However, modern scientific evidence shows exactly the opposite: sleep is one of the periods of greatest regulatory and restorative activity in the human body.

Sleep hygiene refers to the set of habits, routines, and environmental conditions that promote good quality sleep that is sufficient in duration and truly restorative for the body and mind. It doesn't refer to hygiene in the sense of cleanliness, but rather to how we take care of our relationship with rest.

From public health organizations to major medical centers, there is a clear message: improving sleep habits can significantly improve the quality of rest and overall health, even without resorting to drugs.

3.4.2. What exactly is sleep hygiene?

Sleep hygiene can be defined as a set of healthy practices aimed at optimizing the quality of sleep, not just its duration.

Sleeping well involves much more than just spending hours in bed. Healthy sleep is typically characterized by:

- Fall asleep in a reasonable amount of time
- Sleep relatively continuously
- Achieving restful sleep
- Waking up feeling rested
- To function properly during the day

The *Centers for The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC)* emphasizes that sleep quality refers to rest that is continuous and restorative, not simply long.

Therefore, sleep hygiene seeks to protect both the quantity and quality of rest.

3.4.3. Sleep as a regulated behavior

One of the central ideas of sleep hygiene is that simply "feeling sleepy" is not enough. The ability to sleep well depends on how we organize our sleep:

- The day
- The environment
- The schedules
- Mental and sensory stimulation
- The relationship with rest

Sleep is largely regulated by the circadian rhythm, the internal biological clock that synchronizes sleep- -wake cycles. When daily habits are erratic, this system loses coherence, and getting a good night's sleep becomes more difficult.

3.4.4. Fundamental principles of good sleep hygiene

Maintain regular schedules

One of the most important pillars is consistency in scheduling:

- Go to bed at a similar time every night.
- Get up at a similar time every morning
- Maintain some regularity even on weekends

The *Mayo Clinic* highlights that regularity strengthens the sleep- -wake cycle and makes it easier to fall and stay asleep.

Create an environment conducive to rest

The bedroom should act as a clear signal to the brain that it's time to sleep. Generally speaking, it is recommended that it be:

- Dark
- Silent
- Cool or lukewarm
- Comfortable
- Associated with rest (not work or digital leisure)

Both the *Mayo Clinic* and the *CDC* agree that a cool, dark, and quiet room facilitates the onset and continuation of sleep.

Limit screen time before bed

Exposure to screens (mobile phone, tablet , computer, television) before bedtime can interfere with the onset of sleep in two main ways:

- Artificial light can disrupt the biological signal of “preparing for sleep”
- The content keeps the mind in a state of activation.

The *CDC* recommends turning off electronic devices at least 30 minutes before going to sleep, a recommendation also supported by the *Mayo Clinic* .

Avoid stimulants and heavy meals

What you consume in the late afternoon -and evening directly influences your sleep:

- Caffeine and nicotine can interfere for hours.
- Alcohol may induce initial drowsiness but fragment sleep
- Heavy dinners make it difficult to balance work and rest.

The *Mayo Clinic* warns that, although alcohol may "make you sleepy", it generally worsens the quality of sleep in the second half of the night.

Regulate naps

Long or late naps can reduce nighttime sleep pressure. Therefore, when nighttime sleep problems exist, the following is usually recommended:

- Limit the duration of naps
- Avoid late naps
- Do not use them as a regular supplement if they disrupt your main sleep.

This recommendation appears consistently in the *Mayo Clinic guidelines* .

Physical activity and stress reduction

Regular exercise promotes sleep, provided it is not excessively strenuous right before bedtime. Other helpful practices include:

- Deep breathing
- Meditation or mindfulness
- Quiet reading
- Gentle stretches
- Mental disconnection routines

The *Mayo Clinic* notes that exercise improves sleep, but it's advisable to avoid highly stimulating workouts close to bedtime.

3.4.5. Why sleep hygiene is so important

Sleep is not a luxury or unproductive time. The *National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute (NHLBI)* explains that, during sleep, the body:

- Supports brain function
- Facilitates tissue repair
- Regulates hormones
- Strengthens the immune system
- Optimizes daytime functioning

Chronic poor sleep affects virtually all of the body's systems.

3.4.6. Benefits of good sleep hygiene

Physical recovery and energy

Restful sleep allows:

- Better recovery from daily wear and tear
- Cellular and tissue repair
- Less accumulated fatigue
- More energy upon waking

The *NHLBI* emphasizes that sleep supports overall physical health through repair and maintenance processes.

Brain function, memory and attention

Sleeping well is key to mental performance. Good sleep hygiene promotes:

- Memory consolidation
- Effective learning
- Better concentration
- Better decisions
- Faster reactions

The *NHLBI* and the *CDC* agree that adequate sleep improves attention, memory, and problem-solving abilities.

Emotional regulation and stress management

When rest is adequate, the following is usually observed:

- Greater emotional stability
- Reduced irritability
- Improved stress tolerance
- Better mood

The *CDC* indicates that getting enough sleep helps reduce stress and improve mood, while lack of sleep is associated with a higher risk of mood disorders.

Immune system

Good sleep hygiene contributes to:

- Reduced susceptibility to infections
- Improved immune response
- Better inflammation control

The *CDC* notes that getting enough sleep can help you "get sick less often," and the *NHLBI* links uninterrupted sleep to a more efficient immune system.

Metabolism and appetite control

Sleep regulates key hormones like leptin and ghrelin, which are involved in satiety and hunger. Poor sleep can:

- Increase appetite
- Alter glucose
- Worsening insulin sensitivity

The *NHLBI* and the *CDC* emphasize that getting enough sleep helps maintain a more stable metabolism and a healthy weight.

Cardiovascular health

Sleeping properly allows the cardiovascular system to reduce its workload:

- Better blood pressure regulation
- Improved recovery of the heart and blood vessels
- Lower long-term risk of hypertension, heart disease, and stroke

Both the *CDC* and the *NHLBI* highlight the direct relationship between insufficient sleep and increased cardiovascular risk.

3.4.7. Functional impact on daily life

Beyond biological markers, good sleep hygiene usually translates into:

- More daily energy
- Improved academic or work performance
- Fewer mistakes due to carelessness
- Better reaction time
- Less risk of accidents

The *CDC* warns that insufficient sleep increases the risk of traffic accidents and drowsiness-related injuries.

3.4.8. Summary: Sleeping well as an act of self-care

Sleep hygiene is not a one-off technique or a fad. It is a lifestyle strategy that protects an essential biological function.

Taking care of your sleep is equivalent to taking care of your nervous system, metabolism, immune system, cardiovascular health, and emotional well-being. In that sense, sleeping well isn't a waste of time: it's an investment in long-term health.

In short, sleep is treated as a critical performance tool, not a luxury.

3.5. Stress adaptation : Intermittent fasting

3.5.1. Eating is not just about what, but when.

Intermittent fasting is not a diet in the traditional sense. It doesn't prescribe specific foods or impose strict lists of allowed and forbidden foods. Its distinguishing feature is something else: it organizes eating according to time.

In general, intermittent fasting involves alternating periods of eating with periods of no calories consumed—or very few. Therefore, it is often described as a meal timing strategy rather than a traditional diet focused on nutritional content.

This change in approach is relevant because the human body doesn't respond the same way immediately after eating as it does several hours later. Intermittent fasting exploits precisely this metabolic flexibility: the body's ability to switch energy sources depending on the time elapsed since the last meal.

3.5.2. What happens in the body during fasting

After a meal, the body primarily uses glucose from food. In this state, insulin levels rise, facilitating the use of immediate energy and the storage of excess glucose, especially as glycogen and fat.

When several hours pass without eating, insulin levels gradually decrease. In this metabolic context:

- First, liver glycogen reserves are used
- Then the use of fatty acids increases
- During longer periods of fasting, the production of ketone bodies can increase, which is another source of energy for tissues such as the brain.

This change in metabolic state is one of the mechanisms by which intermittent fasting is associated, in some people, with improvements in weight control and certain metabolic parameters.

It's important to emphasize that these processes are not exclusive to intermittent fasting: they occur during any period of energy restriction. What distinguishes them is that fasting concentrates and repeats them in a structured way.

3.5.3. Main types of intermittent fasting

Time- -restricted feeding Eating)

It's the most popular method and, for many people, the most sustainable. It consists of concentrating meals within a specific time window each day and fasting the rest of the time.

Common examples:

- 12/12
- 14/10
- 16/8
- 18/6

A person might, for example, eat between 10:00 AM and 6:00 PM and fast from late -afternoon until the following morning. Part of the fast coincides with sleep, which usually makes it more bearable.

Alternate-day fasting

In this modality, days of normal eating alternate with days of total fasting or very low calorie intake.

- Complete alternate-day fasting: one day you eat, the next you don't.
- Modified alternate-day fasting: one normal day, one with very reduced intake

Although it has shown results in studies, it is usually more difficult to maintain in real life and is not the most common option in non-clinical contexts.

5:2 Method

It consists of eating normally five days a week and then fasting or severely restricting calories for two non-consecutive days. It falls between daily fasting and alternate-day fasting in terms of intensity.

3.5.4. Why many people use it

Intermittent fasting has become popular because, for some people, it simplifies their relationship with food. Instead of constantly counting calories, a clear time rule is established: I eat at this time; I don't eat at this time.

This structure can favor:

- Less snacking
- Fewer impulsive nighttime eating episodes
- Lower total number of food choices
- Greater sense of control

In practice, many people end up consuming fewer calories without explicitly intending to, which explains some of its effects on body weight.

However, it's important to emphasize: intermittent fasting isn't magic. Its results depend on overall habits, individual circumstances, and the overall quality of one's diet.

3.5.5. Observed benefits and their interpretation

Weight control and fat loss

This is the most common reason for starting it. It can facilitate weight loss because:

- Reduce the frequency of intake
- Limit snacking
- It promotes sustained calorie deficits

Evidence suggests that, with equal calorie intake, intermittent fasting is not clearly superior to other dietary strategies. Its main advantage lies in adherence for some individuals.

Metabolism and insulin sensitivity

In some people, intermittent fasting is associated with:

- Better glucose control
- Increased insulin sensitivity
- Triglyceride reduction
- Decreased abdominal circumference
- Slight improvement in blood pressure

These effects are not universal and depend on multiple factors, but they appear consistently in reviews when fasting is integrated into a healthy lifestyle.

Autophagy, metabolic flexibility and the brain

One of the most frequently cited concepts is autophagy, a cellular recycling process that is activated especially in states of energy restriction. Evidence in humans is indirect, but it is considered a plausible mechanism by which fasting could contribute to cellular health.

Fasting can also improve metabolic flexibility, that is, the ability to alternate between glucose and fat as fuel, which some people describe as greater energy stability and mental clarity.

In animal models and preliminary studies, an increase in BDNF (brain-derived neurotrophic factor), related to neuronal plasticity and cognitive health, has been observed, although this effect should still be interpreted with caution in humans.

Food order and cognitive perception

Beyond physiological markers, many people report subjective benefits:

- Less impulsive eating
- Easier digestion
- Less postprandial lethargy
- Greater mental clarity
- Better adherence to routines

These effects can stem from both the timing pattern and the increased awareness of nutrition.

3.5.6. Limitations and important considerations

Intermittent fasting is not suitable for everyone. It should be evaluated with particular caution in:

- Eating disorders
- Pregnancy and breastfeeding
- Diabetes treated with hypoglycemic drugs
- Underweight people
- Situations of high energy demand

Furthermore, if unhealthy habits are maintained during the eating window, the benefit of fasting is diminished.

3.5.7. Summary : Fasting as a tool, not as dogma

Intermittent fasting is not a universal solution or a requirement. It's a time management tool that can be helpful for some people and neutral or negative for others.

Its true value lies not in fasting itself, but in how it is integrated into a coherent lifestyle that includes:

- Quality food
- Regular movement
- Adequate sleep
- Stress management

In that context, intermittent fasting can act as a framework that brings order, not as a magic recipe that replaces the fundamentals of health.

4. What is the NEXUS method used for?

The ultimate goal of the method is to "stretch life" (stretch) lifetime) and ensure that the additional years are of high quality. It is specifically used for:

- Improve body composition and metabolic health: Targets visceral fat, reverses insulin resistance, and protects lean tissue.
- Promote mental clarity: By stabilizing glucose and using ketone bodies as " super fuel " for the brain, it eliminates brain fog and improves neuroplasticity .
- Regulate the endocrine system and reduce stress: Balance hormones such as cortisol, leptin, and testosterone through rest and sexual vitality.
- Preventing degenerative diseases: Activating autophagy and reducing chronic inflammation are key to preventing age-related pathologies such as Alzheimer's or cardiovascular problems.
- Creating a sustainable life framework: Unlike extreme diets, NEXUS offers an adaptable "operating system" where the profile defines the approach, but the person adjusts the parameters according to their age, gender and life context.

The NEXUS method doesn't seek temporary changes, but rather a profound biological adaptation. By integrating these pillars, the individual achieves a synergy where fasting enhances nutrition, strength improves metabolism, sleep repairs the damage from training, and sexual vitality balances the stress generated by modern life, resulting in sustainable health and active longevity.

The objective of this method is not to explain the benefits of each of the pillars, since there is already a lot of literature on them, but to show the most correct way to combine them: nourishing, stimulating, expressing, recovering and adapting the biology of the individual to reach their best possible version at any stage of life.

5. Definition of the NEXUS Foundation profile

Based on the answers you, dear reader, have given in the completed questionnaire, you have been classified into this specific profile.

Foundation profile constitutes the base level or entry-level operating system in the NEXUS methodology. It is defined not by a rigid demographic category, but by a series of behavioral traits and a specific life context that determine its relationship with health and energy.

The following is a detailed definition of this profile:

1. Life context and temporary challenges

Foundation individual is typically at a stage of life marked by a very high level of responsibility. Their daily life is described as a constant "firefighting" dynamic, where available time is an extremely scarce resource due to the overlapping demands of a demanding job and family obligations. This time overload means that any change in routine that involves logistical complications is perceived as an unbearable burden.

2. Psychophysiological state and energy

From a biological and emotional point of view, this profile presents the following characteristics:

- Stress Level: Manages a medium-high level of stress chronically due to their environment.
- Energy Profile: Your vital energy is usually low or irregular throughout the day.
- Relationship with Discomfort: Due to the mental strain of his responsibilities, he has a low tolerance for added discomfort; he tends to avoid extra effort if it does not fit organically into his current routine.

3. Motivation and philosophy of change

The mindset of a person at the Foundation profile level is pragmatic and defensive. Their primary motivation is not high performance or extreme optimization, but rather "getting better and not getting worse." Their philosophy of success is governed by the principle of Consistency > Perfection. They understand that, in their current situation, the key is not to do "the best" according to pure science, but rather "what is sustainable" for their stage of life. The primary objective of this profile within the method is to gain momentum; that is, to establish basic habits that do not generate friction before attempting to climb toward more ambitious goals.

4. Health decision- making

Regarding self-awareness and discipline, the Foundation profile is characterized by:

- Intuition: You make decisions about your well-being based on intuition or on what simply "fits" into your life at a given moment.
- Pursuit of simplicity: Reject complex systems, meticulous food weighings, or rigid training schedules that add more mental "noise" to your life.
- Acceptance of guidance: This profile benefits from a clear and direct framework that frees them from decision fatigue, provided the instructions are easy to integrate socially and professionally.

In summary, the NEXUS Foundation represents the individual who needs to improve their health and longevity without the process becoming an additional source of stress, prioritizing simplicity to ensure that lifestyle changes are maintained over time.

6. Objectives for the NEXUS Foundation profile

For the NEXUS Foundation profile , the primary goal of the method is not extreme optimization or high performance, but rather the creation of a sustainable biological operating system that allows the individual to improve their health and energy without the process becoming an additional source of stress. This profile, which typically includes adults with very busy lives, seeks pragmatic goals focused on consistency over perfection.

The objectives that the NEXUS method specifically pursues for this profile are described in detail below:

1. Recovery of vital energy and mental clarity

The main objective is to get the individual out of the cycle of fatigue and daily "fires".

- Glycemic stability: Through real nutrition and flexible intermittent fasting (16-8), the aim is to stabilize blood sugar levels to eliminate "brain fog" and postprandial energy crashes.
- Activation of the metabolic switch: The aim is for the body to regain the ability to use fats as fuel (mild ketosis), providing a more constant flow of energy to the brain.

2. Slowing down biological degeneration (sarcopenia and osteoporosis)

Since a natural loss of muscle mass begins from the age of 30 (3-5% per decade), the method establishes critical structural goals.

- Muscle as life insurance: The goal is to use full-body strength training to signal myokines , molecules that regulate the health of the liver, pancreas, and brain.
- Bone mineral density: Through basic mechanical loads, the aim is to activate Wolff's law to strengthen bones and prevent osteoporosis in the long term.

3. Efficient stress management and hormonal balance

For a person with medium-high stress, the method does not seek to add more burden, but to use the pillars as regulatory tools.

- Counteracting cortisol: The goal is to use sexual vitality (eXpression pillar) to release oxytocin, which acts as a direct antagonist of cortisol, promoting muscle retention and preventing the accumulation of abdominal fat.
- Sleep hygiene as a mandate: The aim is to establish routines that allow the activation of the glymphatic system during deep sleep to perform a "cleaning of metabolic waste" in the brain, such as beta-amyloid protein.

4. Reversal of chronic systemic inflammation

Foundation profile is often exposed to the "trinity of toxicity" (sugars, refined flours and industrial vegetable oils).

- Escape the "matrix" of ultra-processed foods : The nutritional goal is to regain biological control of satiety signals (leptin) and reduce systemic inflammation, which is the root of most modern diseases.
- Microbiotic health : By prioritizing real food, the aim is to nourish the microbiota to stabilize the immune system and improve mood (90% of serotonin is produced in the gut).

5. Generation of inertia and social sustainability

The NEXUS method recognizes that the biggest mistake is applying extreme strategies to busy people.

- 80/20 Rule: The goal is for 80% of decisions to be biologically correct, allowing 20% social flexibility to ensure the method is sustainable for decades and not just weeks.
- Extreme simplification: The aim is for health not to be just another task on the list, but a framework that is executed almost automatically through high-impact, low-effort habits.

6. Stretching a Healthy Life

The ultimate goal for the Foundation profile is to ensure that the aging process is active and functional.

- Metabolic prevention: The goal is to optimize insulin sensitivity to prevent progression to prediabetes or metabolic syndrome.
- Structural longevity: Building an "armor" of strength and cognitive reserve that allows the individual to reach advanced ages with total independence.

In summary, for the Foundation profile , the NEXUS method serves to win the battle against the wear and tear of modern life, returning to the individual sovereignty over their own biology through interventions that respect their life context and available time.

7. Intermittent fasting strategy

The intermittent fasting strategy for the NEXUS Foundation profile is integrated within the Stress adaptation (S) pillar, using positive or hormetic stress to optimize the individual's biology12. For this profile, characterized as a "busy beginner" with little time and medium-high stress, the method prioritizes simplicity and social sustainability over extreme optimization.

The following describes this strategy in great detail:

1. Selected fasting protocols: 14-10 and 16-8

The Foundation profile uses two entry levels designed to gain momentum without generating vital friction:

- The 14-10 model: This consists of a 14-hour fast and a 10-hour eating window. It is the ideal level for the initial transition or for women who may be more sensitive to metabolic stress.
- The 16-8 model (Leangains): This is considered the "gold standard." It involves fasting for 16 hours and eating within an 8-hour window (for example, from 1:00 PM to 9:00 PM). It is easily achieved by skipping breakfast or dinner, making it highly compatible with an active social and work life.

2. Physiological basis: The "metabolic switch"

The technical goal is to activate the metabolic switch. Normally, the body runs on glucose; however, after about 12 to 16 hours of fasting, liver glycogen stores are depleted, and the body is forced to use fatty acids, which the liver converts into ketone bodies (beta- hydroxybutyrate). These ketones act as a " super fuel " for the brain, providing more stable energy than glucose and eliminating brain fog . *fog*).

3. Step-by-step implementation guide

NEXUS proposes a gradual transition to train metabolic flexibility without suffering:

- Phase A - Adaptation (Weeks 1-2): No time is counted. The sole objective is to eliminate snacking between main meals. This trains the hunger hormone (ghrelin) to stop constantly craving food.
- Phase B - Compression (Weeks 3-4): Breakfast is gradually delayed (for example, going from 08:00 to 10:00 and then to 12:00) until the desired window is reached.
- Phase C - Consolidation: The final schedule is established (e.g., 16-8) and the natural adrenaline boost from morning fasting is used to improve productivity at work.

4. What to consume during fasting (golden rules)

To maintain autophagy (cellular recycling) and fat burning, insulin spikes must be avoided:

- Allowed: Water (with a pinch of sea salt or Himalayan salt to avoid headaches due to lack of electrolytes), black coffee (without milk or sugar), green or black tea, herbal infusions and apple cider vinegar.
- Prohibited: Milk (even a splash cuts autophagy), sugar, honey, "Zero" drinks (they can trigger brain insulin due to the sweet taste) and branched-chain amino acids (BCAAs).

5. How to break the fast correctly

The timing of your first meal is critical. It's recommended to avoid bread and sugar and prioritize high-quality protein and healthy fats (eggs, avocado, chicken, nuts). This helps keep insulin levels stable and prolongs the feeling of fullness. Complex carbohydrates can be included in your last meal of the day if you've exercised, as they help release serotonin and improve sleep quality.

6. Specific benefits achieved

By applying this strategy, the Foundation profile obtains:

- Improving insulin sensitivity: It is the most powerful tool to reverse insulin resistance and prediabetes.
- Visceral fat loss: Specifically targets the dangerous fat surrounding the organs.
- Neuroplasticity : Increases brain-derived neurotrophic factor (BDNF), which acts as "fertilizer" for neurons.
- Gentle autophagy: Activation of the internal cleaning of damaged proteins and old organelles.

7. Precautions and gender

NEXUS warns that women are more sensitive to metabolic stress due to the kisspeptin molecule. Therefore, it is recommended to avoid fasting for more than 16 hours during the luteal phase (the week before menstruation) to protect progesterone balance and prevent problems such as amenorrhea. During these periods, the 14/10 eating pattern is the most suitable.

8. Real fooding strategy

Fooding 's strategy for the NEXUS Foundation profile is based on a pragmatic approach designed for people with demanding schedules and high stress levels. The fundamental goal is not dietary perfection, but rather building momentum through sustainable habits that don't add further friction to daily life.

The comprehensive strategy for this profile is detailed below:

1. The golden rule: "80/20 mindful"

For the Foundation profile , real fooding isn't a restrictive diet, but a framework. The 80/20 rule states that 80% of your diet should be based on real food, while the remaining 20% allows for social flexibility (business dinners, family events, or occasional cravings). This flexibility is critical to avoid mental burnout and ensure the system is sustainable for decades, not just weeks.

2. Understanding the objective: escaping the "matrix"

Real food is defined as food that retains its original form (plants, animals, fungi). The Foundation profile should learn to distinguish between food and "edible products" designed in laboratories to achieve *bliss. point* (the mathematical happiness point between sugar, fat and salt), which hijacks natural satiety signals (leptin).

To simplify this, the NOVA classification system is used:

- Prioritize (90%): Group 1 foods (minimally processed: fruits, vegetables, eggs, meat, fish, nuts).
- Eliminate/Minimize (<10%): Group 4 foods (Ultra-processed foods : soft drinks, industrial pastries, ready-to-heat meals, nuggets).

3. The "trinity of toxicity" to be eliminated

If the busy beginner could only make three changes to dramatically improve their metabolic health, NEXUS recommends eliminating these three items that solve 80% of dietary problems:

1. Liquid sugar: Soft drinks and industrial juices (they trigger an instant insulin spike).
2. Industrial seed oils: Sunflower, corn, or soybean oil. These should be replaced with extra virgin olive oil (EVOO), butter, or coconut oil.
3. Refined flours: White bread, white pasta, and pastries. These should be replaced with tubers (potatoes, sweet potatoes) or legumes in moderation.

4. Purchasing strategy: "perimeter hunting"

Given that the Foundation profile has limited time, shopping must be efficient. Supermarkets are designed to draw the consumer into the central aisles, where long-lasting products are located. The strategy involves shopping almost exclusively in the outer perimeter of the store, where fresh products are found: meat, fish, produce, and basic refrigerated items.

5. Label Reading: The 3-Step Filter

To avoid decision fatigue, the Foundation user applies three quick rules when reading a label:

1. Length: If it has more than 5 ingredients, it's suspicious.
2. Pronounceability : If you can't pronounce an ingredient (monosodium glutamate, high fructose corn syrup), don't eat it.
3. Sugar Alias: If sugar (under any of its 50 names such as maltodextrin or dextrose) is among the first 3 ingredients, put the product back on the shelf.

6. Composition of the " Foundation dish "

To maximize satiety without counting calories, the rainbow visual rule is used:

- 50% Vegetables/Greens: Base of micronutrients and fiber (salads, broccoli, zucchini).
- 25% Quality Protein: Structural and satiating (eggs, fish, meat, tofu).
- 25% Healthy Fats and Tubers: Fuel (avocado, EVOO, nuts, potato).

7. Managing satiety and mindset

The goal is a biological " reset ." You should eat until you reach a satiety level of 8 out of 10, never until you feel "stuffed," to allow your body to regain awareness of its hunger signals.

- Hydration: It's vital to drink water constantly (approximately half your body weight in ounces). A trick to improve absorption and energy is to add a pinch of Himalayan or sea salt to your water.
- Mental preparation: As this is a stressed profile, it is recommended to visualize the day's meal scenario in the morning to avoid impulsive decisions in the face of extreme hunger.

8. Sample Menu for the Foundation Profile

- Food (Breaking the fast): Grilled salmon or a 3-egg omelet, a large salad with avocado and olive oil, and a handful of blueberries.
- Snack (If necessary): A handful of raw almonds or a natural Greek yogurt (full, not 0%).
- Dinner: A quality beef burger (without the bun) or roasted chicken thighs with roasted vegetables (broccoli, carrots). If you worked out in the afternoon, now is the time to include complex carbohydrates to improve sleep.

9. Sleep hygiene strategy

The sleep hygiene strategy for the NEXUS Foundation profile is based on the premise that, for a busy beginner with high levels of responsibility and stress, sleep should not be seen as a luxury, but as an essential biological imperative for cellular repair and hormonal balance. Since this profile seeks to improve their health without adding further strain to their life, the method focuses on basic sleep hygiene that achieves high impact with minimal logistical effort.

The complete strategy, based on the method's sources, is detailed below:

1. The rationale: Why is it critical for the Foundation profile ?

Sleep acts as the "recovery multiplier" for the other pillars of the NEXUS4 method. For a person with moderate to high stress, fulfilling this pillar allows for:

- Brain cleansing (Glymphatic System): During deep sleep (NREM stage 3), the brain activates a "washing" cycle that eliminates metabolic waste such as beta-amyloid protein, linked to Alzheimer's.
- Weight control and satiety: Sleeping properly regulates appetite hormones; lack of sleep increases ghrelin (hunger) and suppresses leptin (satiety), pushing the body to crave carbohydrates and sugars the next day.
- Physical repair: Growth hormone (HGH) spikes, vital for repairing tissue damaged during strength exercise, occur during deep sleep.

2. The action protocol: "10-3-2-1-0"

To simplify execution and eliminate decision fatigue, the Foundation profile uses this chronological protocol:

- 10 hours before bed (Zero Caffeine): Caffeine has a half-life of 5-7 hours and blocks adenosine receptors in the brain, preventing deep sleep.
- 3 hours before bedtime (No large meals or alcohol): Digestion raises core body temperature, making it harder to fall asleep. Alcohol, while tempting, disrupts sleep and suppresses REM sleep.
- 2 hours before bed (Zero work stress): Emails, news or finances that trigger cortisol should be avoided.
- 1 hour before bed (Zero screens): The blue light from devices tricks the brain into thinking it's midday, suppressing the release of melatonin.
- 0 (Zero Snooze): Do not press the snooze button on the alarm; this confuses the brain and causes sleep inertia or morning grogginess.

3. Creation of the " sleep sanctuary"

The physical environment must be optimized so that the body lowers its defenses naturally:

- Cool temperature: The ideal environment should be around 18°C (65°F), as the body needs its internal temperature to drop in order to begin resting.
- Absolute darkness: The use of blackout curtains or eye masks is recommended, eliminating even small lights from chargers or clocks that disrupt melatonin.
- Silence and comfort: Use white noise machines if the environment is noisy and ensure that the mattress and pillow are comfortable.

4. Low-effort complementary habits

- Exposure to sunlight: Getting at least 30 minutes of natural light during the day (preferably in the morning) helps anchor the circadian rhythm.
- Hot bath: Taking a hot bath before going to bed facilitates the drop in body temperature upon exiting, mimicking the natural process of falling asleep.
- The 20-minute rule: If you haven't fallen asleep after 20 minutes in bed, the method suggests getting up and doing a relaxing activity in another room to avoid associating the bed with the anxiety of not sleeping.

5. Synergy with the NEXUS system

For the Foundation profile , sleep hygiene is not isolated:

- With Fasting (S): Eating dinner early thanks to fasting releases energy that would otherwise be spent on nighttime digestion.
- With Real Fooding (N): Consuming real foods provides magnesium (green vegetables, nuts) and tryptophan (eggs, turkey), which are precursors to serotonin and melatonin.
- With Exercise (E): Strength training early in the day improves the depth of later sleep, although vigorous exercise just before bedtime should be avoided.

Foundation user strategy seeks to establish a regular sleep-wake schedule and optimize the rest environment, allowing the body's biology to perform its maintenance functions automatically and without generating additional stress for the individual.

10. Strength training strategy

The Strength Training strategy for the NEXUS Foundation profile is based on the "E" (Exercise) pillar of the method, which is defined as the essential stimulus for maintaining a youthful and functional body. For this profile—the "busy beginner" with limited time and high stress—the fundamental premise is to obtain maximum biological benefit with minimal logistical effort, prioritizing basic movements that generate long-term health momentum.

The complete strategy is detailed below, divided into its physiological foundations, programming, and execution:

1. The biological paradigm: Muscle as life insurance

In the NEXUS system, muscle is not trained for aesthetics, but because it is the largest endocrine organ in the body.

- Myokine signaling : When the muscle contracts against heavy resistance, it releases molecules called myokines (such as IL-6 and Irisin), which travel through the bloodstream communicating with the liver, pancreas, bones, and brain to optimize their function.
- Slowing down sarcopenia: From the age of 30, humans naturally lose between 3% and 5% of muscle mass per decade. Strength training is the only tool capable of halting this degenerative process.
- Metabolic and bone health: Muscle is the body's largest glucose storage site; more muscle mass means better insulin sensitivity and a lower risk of diabetes. Furthermore, according to Wolff's Law, mechanical stress strengthens bones against osteoporosis by activating calcium-building cells.

2. Direct impact on longevity

The science behind NEXUS shows compelling benefits for the Foundation profile :

- Performing any amount of strength training reduces the risk of mortality from all causes by 15-21%, from cardiovascular disease by 19%, and from cancer by 14%.
- Optimal dose: The point of greatest return for health is found at around 60 minutes per week, where a maximum reduction in the risk of mortality of 27-33% is observed.

3. Programming: The Full-Body Routine

To avoid friction, the Foundation profile trains only 2 or 3 days a week (e.g., Monday/ Wednesday / Friday) using a full-body routine focused on the "Big Five" compound movements.

To achieve this, NEXUS proposes the Linear Progression protocol, according to which two sessions (A and B) are alternated to ensure the recovery of the central nervous system:

- Session A:

    1. Squat : 3 sets of 5 repetitions. Works the largest muscle groups.
    2. Bench Press: 3 sets of 5 repetitions. Upper body pushing strength.
    3. Barbell Row: 3 sets of 8-10 repetitions. Essential for posture.

- Session B:

    4. Deadlift : 1 heavy set of 5 repetitions. It is the purest test of strength and builds a "shielded" back.
    5. Military Press (Overhead Press): 3 sets of 5 repetitions. Requires core stability .
    6. Pull-ups or Pull-ups: 3 sets of 8-10 repetitions.

4. Key operating principles

For the strategy to be effective without being overwhelming, these rules must be followed:

- Progressive overload: The body only changes if the stimulus increases. The goal is to try to add between 1.25 kg and 2.5 kg to the bar in each session, provided that the repetitions are completed with good technique.
- Repetition ranges: You should spend 70% of your time in the 5-8 repetition range, which offers the best balance between neurological strength and muscle growth (hypertrophy).
- Rest between sets: When training hard, you need 2 to 3 minutes of rest for cellular ATP to recover. Resting for less than 60 seconds is like training with your "tank half empty."
- Footwear: Use flat-soled shoes (or train barefoot if possible) to ensure stability, avoiding running soles which are unstable for heavy loads.

5. Synergy with other NEXUS pillars

Foundation strength training is not an isolated habit, but is enhanced by other systems:

- With Fasting (S): Training in a fasted state can raise the growth hormone (HGH), although if the user feels weak, they can consume some salt water before the session.
- With Real Fooding (N): The post-workout period is the most critical time to consume real food rich in carbohydrates (potatoes, fruit) and protein, as insulin sensitivity is at its peak and nutrients are directed straight to muscle repair.
- With Sleep (U): Muscle damage generated in the gym is repaired in bed. Most HGH is released during deep sleep, acting as a multiplier of the results obtained in training.
- With Sexual Vitality (X): Heavy compound exercises are the most effective natural way to increase free testosterone and vital energy, which directly fuels the eXpression pillar .

In summary, the Foundation strategy seeks to transform the individual into a "healthy beast" through an efficient framework that protects their longevity without complicating their daily life.

11. Sexual life strategy

The active sex life strategy for the NEXUS Foundation profile is integrated into the "X" (eXpression) pillar of the method, which represents the individual's vital, hormonal, and emotional energy.1 For a busy beginner, whose life is marked by high levels of stress and responsibilities, this pillar does not focus on performance, but on using sexuality as a powerful neurobiological regulator to counteract daily wear and tear.

The strategy is detailed below with scientific and operational depth:

1. The central strategy: "prioritize the context"

For the Foundation profile , the goal is not to add additional pressure on frequency or performance, but rather to create the biological and environmental conditions that allow for the expression of vitality. Since this profile typically operates in "survival" mode due to chronic cortisol, the strategy focuses on:

- Reduction of allostatic load : Stress is the main inhibitor of libido; if the body perceives danger (work stress or lack of sleep), it prioritizes survival over reproduction.
- Rest over performance: Sleep and disconnection are prioritized as prerequisites for a healthy sex life.
- Basic communication: Establish simple dialogues about needs and boundaries to reduce emotional friction in the couple.

2. The biological basis: stress regulation

Sexual health acts as a biomarker of longevity and a critical hormonal balancer:

- The antidote to cortisol (oxytocin): Sexual activity and physical contact release oxytocin, known as the "bonding hormone." This molecule acts as a direct antagonist to cortisol, promoting muscle mass retention, reducing abdominal fat, and fostering calmness.
- DHEA Boost: Sexuality can temporarily raise levels of DHEA, the steroid precursor to testosterone and estrogen that typically declines with age, supporting immune function and bone density.
- Endothelial health: Sex is a form of moderate exercise that improves the function of the endothelium (the lining of blood vessels), facilitating better systemic blood flow and reducing cardiovascular risk.

3. Systemic benefits for the Foundation profile

Implementing this strategy generates benefits that directly impact the health challenges of this profile:

- Immune strengthening: Regular sexual activity increases levels of Immune Globulin A (IgA), the first line of defense against pathogens in mucous membranes.
- Pain management: Endorphins released during orgasm act as natural painkillers, raising the pain threshold and improving physical recovery after exercise.
- Structural health: In men, ejaculatory frequency is associated with a lower long-term risk of prostate cancer. In women, it strengthens the pelvic floor muscles, improving bladder control and core stability , and is synergistic with strength training.

4. Cognitive and emotional impact

For a person with "brain fog" and stress, sexual vitality offers:

- Improved mood: The release of dopamine enhances motivation and reduces the likelihood of depressive symptoms. There is evidence that a satisfying sex life predicts better positive affect at work the following day.
- Mental clarity: By reducing cortisol, cognitive resources are released, improving working memory and resilience to external factors.

5. Practical tactics for the busy beginner

NEXUS proposes actions with low logistical effort but high biological impact:

- Scheduling Intimacy: While it may seem unromantic, for a busy person, scheduling moments of connection eliminates the stress of "when will we have time?" and ensures that the activity is a health priority.
- Focus on quality over frequency: The aim is to connect and reduce performance anxiety, maximizing hormonal benefits.
- Non-sexual physical contact: The simple act of hugging or cuddling reduces cortisol levels and strengthens the emotional bond without the pressure of the full sexual act.

6. Synergy in the NEXUS system

eXpression pillar is fed back by the other four:

- With Nutrition and Fasting (N/S): Consuming real food provides zinc and vitamin D, essential building blocks for sex hormones.
- With Exercise (E): Compound exercises (such as squats) increase free testosterone, the main driver of libido.
- With Sleep (U): Poor sleep reduces testosterone and raises cortisol; prioritizing sleep is "fuel" for intimacy. In turn, the release of prolactin after orgasm facilitates entry into deep sleep.

In conclusion, for the NEXUS Foundation profile , sex life is not an optional luxury, but a biological maintenance tool designed to reduce inflammation, balance stress, and extend healthy life through human connection.

12. Conclusions and action plan

For the NEXUS Foundation profile , the method is not presented as a goal of perfectionism, but as a process of gaining biological inertia. The objective is to "extend life" through an operating system that reduces friction and stress, returning sovereignty over one's own health to people with a heavy workload.

The following presents the systemic conclusions and the detailed Comprehensive Action Plan for implementing the NEXUS method in this profile.

12.1. Conclusions: The biological impact on the Foundation profile

The integration of the 5 pillars seeks to transform the physiology of the "busy beginner" from a state of survival to one of active maintenance:

1. Metabolic flexibility: By alternating fasting (F) with real food (N), the body learns to activate the "metabolic switch," shifting from burning only glucose to using ketones. This eliminates brain fog and provides stable energy throughout the workday.
2. Structural and hormonal protection: Strength training (E) is not aesthetic; it seeks to secrete myokines (muscle hormones) that protect the brain and metabolism7. This is complemented by sexual vitality (X), where oxytocin acts as a direct antagonist of cortisol, reducing stress-induced abdominal fat.
3. Systemic hygiene: Sleep (U) activates the glymphatic system , performing a "brainwashing" of metabolic waste (such as beta-amyloid protein), while fasting activates autophagy for cellular recycling of damaged proteins.
4. Social sustainability: The 80/20 rule in nutrition ensures that the method does not isolate the person from their family or professional environment, allowing for lifelong adherence.

12.2. NEXUS Foundation Action Plan (print this sheet)

This plan is designed to be executed in a coordinated manner, maximizing profit with minimal time invested.

1. Pillar S (Stress Adaptation): Gradual Protocol 16-8
   - Immediate action: Completely eliminate snacking between meals to train ghrelin (hunger hormone).
   - Progression: Delay breakfast by 2 hours every 3 days until reaching an 8-hour eating window (e.g., 1:00 PM to 9:00 PM).
   - Golden Rule: During fasting, only water with a pinch of sea salt (for electrolytes), black coffee, or green tea are allowed.
2. Pilar N (Proper Nutrition): Perimeter shopping and the 80/20 rule
   - Shopping strategy: Buy exclusively in the outer perimeter of the supermarket (fresh produce) to avoid the "matrix" of ultra-processed foods .
   - Elimination of the "trinity of toxicity": Eliminate liquid sugars, industrial seed oils (sunflower, corn) and refined flours.
   - Dish composition: 50% vegetables, 25% quality protein, and 25% healthy fats or tubers. Eat until you feel 8/10 full.
3. Pilar E (Exercise): Full- body routine "The Big 5"
   - Frequency: 2 to 3 days per week (e.g., Monday, Wednesday , Friday).
   - Compound movements: Focus on Squat, Deadlift, Bench Press, Military Press and Barbell Row.
   - Optimal dosage: Perform 3 sets of 5-8 repetitions per exercise. Aim to add between 1.25kg and 2.5kg to the bar each session (Progressive overload).
4. Pillar U (Unwind): The 10-3-2-1-0 Protocol
   - 10 hours before bed: Zero caffeine .
   - 3 hours before: No large meals or alcohol.
   - 2 hours before: Zero work stress (don't check emails or finances).
   - 1 hour before: Zero screens (blue light) to allow the natural release of melatonin.
   - 0 Snooze : Get up immediately when the alarm sounds to avoid the inertia of sleep.
   - The Sanctuary: Room at 18°C, total darkness and silence (or white noise).
5. Pillar X (eXpression): Prioritize context
   - Focus on Connection: Not focusing on frequency, but on reducing performance anxiety to maximize the release of oxytocin and DHEA.
   - Scheduling: Schedule intimate moments so that they stop being a "to-do" and become a hormonal health priority.
   - Synergy: Perform strength training early to raise free testosterone, which naturally fuels libido.

summary for the Foundation profile :

Day	Pilar S (Fasting)	Pilar N (Food)	Pillar E (Strength)	Pilar U (Dream)
Monday	16h Fasting	100% Real Food	Session A (Force)	Protocol 10-3-2-1-0
Tuesday	16h Fasting	100% Real Food	Active rest	Protocol 10-3-2-1-0
Wednesday	16h Fasting	100% Real Food	Session B (Strength)	Protocol 10-3-2-1-0
Thursday	16h Fasting	100% Real Food	Active rest	Protocol 10-3-2-1-0
Friday	16h Fasting	80/20 (Social)	Session A (Force)	Protocol 10-3-2-1-0
Saturday	14h Fasting	80/20 (Social)	Long walk	Focus on Pillar X
Sunday	Circadian (12/12)	Real Food	Long walk	Full recovery

13. Final message for the user

You've taken the first step toward reclaiming sovereignty over your own biology, and that in itself is a victory. The NEXUS method isn't a fad diet or a set of tricks; it's a coherent life framework designed to align you with your evolutionary blueprint. You're about to hit your body's "reset button" to clear system errors and optimize your biological "software."

However, for this journey to be successful, you must arm yourself with the most powerful tool for longevity: patience. We live in a culture of instant gratification, but your physiology doesn't operate at the click of a button. Your body needs between two and four weeks to become metabolically flexible and learn to burn fat efficiently after years of glucose dependence. You're not looking for a superficial aesthetic change for the next month; you're building armor for the rest of your life.

Remember that the five pillars work in perfect synergy:

- Real Nutrition (N) provides the building blocks without hijacking your brain with industrial additives.
- Strength training (E) turns your muscle into an endocrine organ that communicates health to your entire body.
- Sexual Vitality (X) is your master stress regulator, restoring your hormonal balance.
- Sleep (U) is the "brainwashing" that repairs daily damage.
- Fasting (S) activates your "internal pharmacy" and the cellular recycling of autophagy.

Be aware that the biggest mistake is falling into the trap of perfectionism. NEXUS is based on the principle that consistency beats perfection. That's why we apply the 80/20 or 90/10 rule: if the vast majority of your decisions are biologically sound, your body will have the resilience needed to handle social flexibility without guilt or setbacks.

Don't compare yourself to someone else's profile; this method is an "operating system" that adapts to your stage of life, whatever it may be. If you slip up one day, don't punish yourself: simply return to the pattern the next day. Your ultimate goal is "Stretch Lifetime ": stretching not only the length of your life, but the quality of every minute you spend in it, ensuring you reach your golden years with energy, mental clarity, and independence.

Trust the process, listen to your body, and keep going. You're designed to thrive, not just survive. Welcome to your best self!

14. NEXUS Support

This is a practical guide designed to help you integrate the five core pillars of the NEXUS Method into your daily life in a simple and effective way. Its purpose is to provide clarity and a strong foundation to build your health, energy, and longevity. However, if you are looking for a deeper and more personalized approach, you can access NEXUS Support, our advanced coaching service. Discover how to unlock the full potential of the method on our website.

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